

Founded: 1999

Sector: Dignity-Based Development, Disaster Relief, Rural Development

Goonj was established in 1999 by Anshu Gupta and Meenakshi Gupta in Delhi with 67 pieces of clothing from their home to address the overlooked basic need of clothing as a tool for dignity and rural development.

Founded by Anshu Gupta after witnessing disaster relief failures where aid ignored dignity, Goonj grew from urban surplus collection to India's largest clothing-based development platform across 27 states. Pioneered "Cloth as Resource"—urban waste becomes rural currency triggering water conservation, sanitation, menstrual hygiene via Not Just a Piece of Cloth campaign.

Service Categories:

Cloth as Development Resource: Recycles urban surplus (3,500+ tonnes/year) for rural barter/development work.

Disaster Response & Rehabilitation: Dignity-focused relief reaching remote areas ignored by govt/NGOs.

Problems They Solve

Climate Emergencies & Environmental Action

Repurposed Material based Livelihood

Education

WASH – Water, Sanitation, Health & Hygiene

Access & Infrastructure

Impact across 2014-2025

72 Millions

Kgs of Material Handled

31

Presence in States / UT

110000 +

Total community development projects

3.5 Million

Total Units of Quilts and Sitting mats

20 Millions

Approx Lives touched through Goonj work

1.3 Millions

Approx Persondays of work created

11 Million

Total Units of Goonj MY Pad



Goonj Initiatives

Cloth For Work (CFW)

Urban surplus clothing becomes rural "currency" rewarding village development labor; communities built bamboo bridges, wells, bunding, irrigation canals, schools, roads, water harvesting using own manpower; triggers community pride + infrastructure.

School to School (S2S)

Affluent urban school surplus (notebooks, pencils, bottles) reaches remote/slum schools as behavior change tool—not charity; prevents dropouts due to stationery costs; comprehensive mindset shift for contributors/recipients



Green by Goonj

100+ upcycled products (purses, bags, mats) from jeans, audio tapes, scrap paper by slum women; funds rural work regardless of grants; showcases craftsmanship + sustainability.

SARRD (Disaster Alliance)

First global cross-sector alliance pre-committing resources for rapid disaster response; coordinates govt/NGOs/corporates; bottoms-up coordinated mitigation transforming relief ecosystem [goonj.org/sarrd].

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